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# Product Epics: Construction Payroll Setup (MVP)

**Product Scope:** Construction Payroll Embedded Onboarding Wizard

**Target Segment:** Small Contractors (1–10 employees), Single-State (MVP Safe States only)

**Primary Goal:** Eliminate "Setup Anxiety" and accelerate time-to-value for non-expert users.

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## 1. Epic Set Overview

| ID     | Epic Title                                              | Summary                                                                                                    |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Epic 1 | "Guided Experience" Wizard Framework & State Management | The linear, "plain-language" navigation shell that guides users and saves progress to prevent data loss.   |
| Epic 2 | Core Entity Integration & Profile Sync                  | API integration to pull Company Profile data from the Core Financials GL, preventing double-entry.         |
| Epic 3 | Banking Connectivity & Instant Verification (IAV)       | Secure linking of the funding account using third-party verification (e.g., Plaid) to minimize fraud risk. |
| Epic 4 | Payroll Scheduling & Calendar Logic                     | Configuration of pay frequency and dates to establish the "heartbeat" of the payroll cycle.                |

|               |                                                                   |                                                                                                                             |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Epic 5</b> | <b>Federal Tax Configuration &amp; Identity Validation</b>        | Captures Federal IDs and acts as the first compliance guardrail by validating the legal entity type.                        |
| <b>Epic 6</b> | <b>State Tax Jurisdiction, Guardrails &amp; SUI Configuration</b> | The critical "Gatekeeper" that detects state jurisdiction, blocks unsupported states (e.g., CA/NY), and captures SUI rates. |
| <b>Epic 7</b> | <b>Local Tax Logic &amp; Complexity Filtering</b>                 | Scans for complex local tax obligations based on address and ensures the user remains within the "Simple" MVP scope.        |
| <b>Epic 8</b> | <b>Digital Authorization (E-File/E-Pay)</b>                       | Digitizes the legal handshake (Form 8655), allowing the system to file taxes on the user's behalf.                          |
| <b>Epic 9</b> | <b>Construction Policy Capture (Workers' Comp)</b>                | Records Workers' Comp policy details to enable downstream job costing and accurate labor burden reporting.                  |

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## 2. Detailed Product Epics

### Epic 1: "Guided Experience" Wizard Framework & State Management

**Goal / Outcome:** Deliver a linear, "plain-language" onboarding wizard that abstracts complex requirements into simple steps. The goal is to eliminate "Setup Anxiety" and support a "Save and Resume" workflow so users don't lose progress if they get interrupted.

- **Primary Personas:** Owner-Operator, Office Manager.
- **Business & PRD Drivers:** FR-1.1 (Welcome), FR-60 (Save & Exit), Metric: Setup Completion Rate >80%.
- **Problem / Rationale:** Users suffer from "Regulatory Paralysis." A generic form interface

increases cognitive load; they need a "hand-holding" experience.

- **In Scope:**
  - "Welcome" splash screen setting expectations for required documents (EIN, Bank credentials).
  - Linear navigation steps (Next/Back) with progress indicators.
  - "Save and Exit" functionality allowing users to leave and return to the same state.
  - Dashboard "Empty State" (pre-setup) showing pending tasks.
- **Out of Scope:**
  - "Help Chat" or Live Support integration (Chat tool implementation is separate).
- **Acceptance Criteria Themes:**
  - User can navigate from Welcome to Finish without technical errors.
  - Closing the browser in the middle of a step saves all previous data.
  - Progress bar accurately reflects the user's position in the journey.

## Epic 2: Core Entity Integration & Profile Sync

**Goal / Outcome:** Accelerate time-to-value by pre-filling Company Profile data from the Core Financials solution, ensuring the "One Envelope" data integrity promise.

- **Primary Personas:** Office Manager.
- **Business & PRD Drivers:** FR-1.2 (Pre-fill), FR-1.3 (Contact Validation), E-2 (Company & Profile Sync).
- **Problem / Rationale:** Manual data entry leads to "Chain of Custody" errors where payroll data doesn't match the General Ledger (GL).
- **In Scope:**
  - API sync to pull Legal Name, Address, and Entity Type from Trimble Financials Core.
  - UI to confirm or edit synced details (Source of Truth validation).
  - Validation of Primary Payroll Contact (Signatory) details.
- **Out of Scope:**
  - Bi-directional sync (pushing payroll changes back to Core master data) - MVP is Read from Core only.
- **Acceptance Criteria Themes:**
  - When the wizard launches, Company Name and Address are already populated.
  - User cannot proceed without a valid Signatory assigned.
  - Address changes in the wizard trigger a validation check against USPS standards.

## Epic 3: Banking Connectivity & Instant Verification (IAV)

**Goal / Outcome:** Securely link a funding account for tax and net pay, instantly verifying ownership to prevent fraud and reduce setup time (replacing the 3-5 day micro-deposit wait).

- **Primary Personas:** Owner-Operator (Financial risk holder).
- **Business & PRD Drivers:** FR-2.2 (IAV), FR-2.3 (Funding Account), UC-3 (Bank Connection).
- **Problem / Rationale:** Owners want to "set it and forget it" quickly. Manual verification is

a high drop-off point.

- **In Scope:**
  - Integration with Banking Provider (e.g., Plaid/Stripe) for Instant Account Verification (IAV).
  - UI for selecting a single funding account for both Net Pay and Taxes.
  - Fallback workflow (manual account entry) if IAV fails.
- **Out of Scope:**
  - Split funding (multiple bank accounts for different liabilities).
  - Credit checks or risk underwriting (assumed handled by platform layer).
- **Acceptance Criteria Themes:**
  - User can successfully link a bank account via credentials login.
  - System validates the account is a business account (where supported).
  - "Run Payroll" is disabled until banking is verified.

## Epic 4: Payroll Scheduling & Calendar Logic

**Goal / Outcome:** Establish the payroll cadence, automatically calculating pay periods and check dates to ensure accurate time-keeping and GL posting.

- **Primary Personas:** Office Manager.
- **Business & PRD Drivers:** FR-2.1 (Pay Schedule), UC-2 (Schedule Config), Metric: Time-to-First-Run.
- **Problem / Rationale:** Construction payroll often has specific weekly cadences. Configuration errors here cause "Friday Crunch" panic.
- **In Scope:**
  - Selection of Pay Frequency (Weekly, Bi-Weekly, Semi-Monthly, Monthly).
  - Definition of "Pay Period End Date" and "Check Date."
  - Automatic calculation and display of the "First Pay Date" based on selection.
- **Out of Scope:**
  - Multiple pay schedules for different employee groups (e.g., Weekly for Field, Bi-Weekly for Office).
- **Acceptance Criteria Themes:**
  - Selecting "Weekly" automatically suggests valid future pay dates.
  - System prevents selecting a Check Date that is before the Pay Period End Date.

## Epic 5: Federal Tax Configuration & Identity Validation

**Goal / Outcome:** Establish the "Federal Identity" of the business. This epic ensures the EIN and Entity Type are valid and match IRS records to prevent filing rejections.

- **Primary Personas:** Office Manager.
- **Business & PRD Drivers:** FR-3.1 (EIN), UC-1, E-4 (Tax Logic - Federal Component).
- **Problem / Rationale:** Incorrect EINs or mismatched Entity Types (e.g., LLC vs. S-Corp) cause cascading failures in tax filing.
- **In Scope:**

- **Federal Guardrail:** Validation of EIN format (XX-XXXXXXX) and check digit logic.
- **Entity Guardrail:** Confirmation that the Entity Type synced from Core (Epic 2) is supported for Federal Payroll (blocking "Non-Profit" or "Govt" if out of scope).
- Entry of Federal Filer Status (Form 941 vs. 944 frequency).
- **Out of Scope:**
  - Applying for a new EIN (User must have it prior).
  - Correction of Entity Type (must be fixed in the Core Financials system).
- **Acceptance Criteria Themes:**
  - System rejects invalid EIN formats (e.g., wrong length, invalid prefix).
  - User confirms Federal tax classification matches their IRS letter.
  - "Federal Setup" step is marked complete only when all fields pass validation.

## Epic 6: State Tax Jurisdiction, Guardrails & SUI Configuration

**Goal / Outcome:** The primary "Gatekeeper" for the MVP. This epic analyzes the company address to determine the State, **blocks unsupported states** (like CA, NY), and captures State Unemployment (SUI) rates for valid users.

- **Primary Personas:** Owner-Operator (Risk Averse).
- **Business & PRD Drivers:** FR-3.2 (Determine Requirements), FR-3.3 (Block Complex States), FR-3.4 (SUI Rates).
- **Problem / Rationale:** The MVP is legally restricted to "Safe States" (No State Income Tax). Allowing a user from a complex state to proceed creates immediate compliance liability.
- **In Scope:**
  - **State Guardrail (Critical):** Logic to map Company Address -> State. If State is NOT in the "Safe List" (TX, FL, TN, WA, NV, SD, WY), **hard block** the user and redirect to waitlist.
  - **State Identification:** Prompt for State-specific Tax IDs (e.g., "TWC Account Number" for Texas) based on the detected state.
  - **Rate Capture:** Input field for State Unemployment Insurance (SUI) rate.
- **Out of Scope:**
  - Multi-state nexus (employees working in a different state than the company).
  - State Income Tax withholding calculations (MVP is 0% SIT states only).
- **Acceptance Criteria Themes:**
  - User with a Texas address is allowed to proceed and asked for Texas-specific IDs.
  - User with a California address receives a specific "Not Supported" modal and cannot advance.
  - SUI rate field accepts up to 4 decimal places (standard for state rates).

## Epic 7: Local Tax Logic & Complexity Filtering

**Goal / Outcome:** Ensure the user is not subject to complex local tax jurisdictions (e.g., city/county taxes) that are out of scope for the MVP.

- **Primary Personas:** Office Manager.
- **Business & PRD Drivers:** FR-3.2 (Local Requirements), FR-3.3 (Block Complex Locals), UC-4 (Local Guardrail).
- **Problem / Rationale:** Even in "Safe States," specific zip codes may have local tax/bond obligations. The system must detect these to avoid under-withholding.
- **In Scope:**
  - **Local Guardrail:** Analyze Company Address (Zip+4) against a local tax database.
  - **Blocking Logic:** If a "Complex Local" jurisdiction is detected (e.g., a specific transit tax or city tax requiring separate registration), block or warn the user depending on risk appetite.
  - **Confirmation:** If no locals are detected, system explicitly logs "No Local Taxes Applicable" for the audit trail.
- **Out of Scope:**
  - Registration for local tax accounts.
  - Calculation of complex school district taxes (OH/PA style).
- **Acceptance Criteria Themes:**
  - System queries tax engine using Zip+4 to identify local jurisdictions.
  - Users in locations with no local taxes auto-complete this step without manual input.
  - Audit log records that local tax check was performed and passed.

## Epic 8: Digital Authorization (E-File/E-Pay)

**Goal / Outcome:** Digitizes the legal handshake (Forms 8655/Auth) to allow the system to file taxes and move money, achieving the "Set it and forget it" goal.

- **Primary Personas:** Owner-Operator (Signatory).
- **Business & PRD Drivers:** FR-4.1 (Auth Forms), UC-5 (Reg Auth), E-5.
- **Problem / Rationale:** Without this, the system cannot offer full-service payroll, forcing users back to manual work.
- **In Scope:**
  - Dynamic generation of Form 8655 (Federal) and relevant State authorization forms.
  - Digital signature capture (e-sign) flow.
  - Storage of signed documents for compliance auditing.
- **Out of Scope:**
  - Physical mailing of forms (must be digital).
- **Acceptance Criteria Themes:**
  - User can view the legal text before signing.
  - Signature is applied to the official PDF form.
  - System flags the account as "Authorized" upon completion.

## Epic 9: Construction Insurance Policy Capture (Workers' Comp)

**Goal / Outcome:** Capture Workers' Compensation data to support future job costing, addressing the "Strategic Differentiator" for construction SMBs.

- **Primary Personas:** Office Manager.
- **Business & PRD Drivers:** FR-4.2 (Workers Comp), Insight 3 (Job Costing).
- **Problem / Rationale:** Generic payroll tools ignore this, but for construction, labor burden (including WC) is critical for profitability.
- **In Scope:**
  - Entry of Carrier Name, Policy Number, and Rate Class.
  - Association of WC codes to the default payroll setup (High level).
- **Out of Scope:**
  - "Pay-as-you-go" integration (connecting directly to carriers) - data entry only for MVP.
- **Acceptance Criteria Themes:**
  - User can save policy number and carrier details.
  - Data is stored in a format retrievable for GL job costing reports.

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### 3. Traceability Matrix

| Requirement ID / Source | Short Description                  | Covered by Epic(s)             |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| FR-1.1                  | Welcome Wizard & Expectations      | Epic 1                         |
| FR-1.2 / FR-1.3         | Pre-fill Company Profile & Contact | Epic 2                         |
| FR-2.1                  | Pay Schedule Selection             | Epic 4                         |
| FR-2.2 / FR-2.3         | Banking IAV Integration            | Epic 3                         |
| FR-3.1                  | Validate Federal EIN               | Epic 5                         |
| FR-3.2                  | Determine Tax Requirements         | Epic 5, 6, 7                   |
| FR-3.3                  | Block Complex Jurisdictions        | Epic 6 (State), Epic 7 (Local) |
| FR-3.4                  | SUI Rate Entry                     | Epic 6                         |

|                           |                                  |              |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------|
| <b>FR-4.1</b>             | E-File Authorization /<br>E-Sign | Epic 8       |
| <b>FR-4.2</b>             | Workers Comp Policy Entry        | Epic 9       |
| <b>UC-1</b>               | Federal Tax Setup                | Epic 5       |
| <b>UC-4</b>               | System Guardrail (MVP<br>States) | Epic 6       |
| <b>Metric: Tax Errors</b> | 0% State config errors           | Epic 5, 6, 7 |